

THE RIG-READY CHECKLIST

Ghost Subie Adventures — Preparedness Without Panic

The exact pre-trip checklist we run before every family camp.

Print this. Laminate it. Keep it in the glovebox. Run it top to bottom before every trip — the whole thing takes ten minutes and it has saved us more weekends than we can count.

VEHICLE — BEFORE YOU ROLL

- ☐ Tires at proper pressure, **including the spare** — and you know where the jack lives
- ☐ Fluids topped: oil, coolant, washer fluid. No new leaks underneath.
- ☐ Battery terminals clean and tight; jumper pack charged
- ☐ All lights working: headlights, brake lights, turn signals, hazards
- ☐ Fuel: enough range for the route **plus a reserve** — know your next fill-up
- ☐ Recovery gear reachable, not buried: straps, shackles, traction boards
- ☐ Roof load and awning secured — nothing that can shift at highway speed
- ☐ Brakes feel right on a test stop before you hit the highway

CAMP SYSTEMS

- ☐ Shelter: tent or rooftop tent, stakes, guylines, ground tarp
- ☐ Sleep: bags rated for the forecast low, sleeping pads, pillows
- ☐ Kitchen: stove + fuel, lighter **and** backup, pot/pan, utensils, cooler with a meal plan
- ☐ Water: drinking supply plus a filter or treatment backup
- ☐ Fire kit in a waterproof bag — and know the local burn rules before you strike a match
- ☐ Power: battery bank charged, headlamps for everyone, spare batteries
- ☐ Chairs, trash bags, and a plan to leave camp cleaner than you found it

PERSONAL READINESS

- ☐ First-aid kit stocked for the realistic stuff — and you actually know how to use it
- ☐ Personal meds, sunscreen, bug protection
- ☐ Warm layer per person, rain layer if the sky looks moody
- ☐ Phones charged, offline maps downloaded, and **someone knows your route and return time**
- ☐ Kid kit: snacks, water, layers, headlamp, comfort item
- ☐ Dog kit: water, food, leash, waste bags

THE 60-SECOND TRAILHEAD SCAN

- ☐ **Walk the full rig:** tires, roof, hitch, awning — anything loose or low?
- ☐ **Look underneath:** fresh drips or anything hanging?
- ☐ **Check the dash:** fuel level, warning lights, tire pressure light
- ☐ **Seatbelts on,** kid and dog secured
- ☐ **One last look at camp:** nothing left behind, fire dead out

EMERGENCY IF-THENS

- ☐ **IF stuck:** stop, assess, air down, traction boards before the shovel — never spin blindly
- ☐ **IF lost:** stop moving, check the paper map, retrace to your last known point
- ☐ **IF someone's hurt:** stabilize, treat what you can, **call for help early** — don't wait until it's worse
- ☐ **IF weather turns:** secure camp first, then decide — the mountain will be there next weekend
- ☐ **IF the rig won't start:** jumper pack first, then the call list — know who you're calling and whether you have signal

THE ~\$50 STARTER KIT

- ☐ Tire plug kit (~\$10) — the number-one trip saver
- ☐ Budget 12V tire compressor (~\$25) — pairs with the plug kit
- ☐ Basic first-aid kit (~\$10) — blisters, burns, bandages
- ☐ Headlamp (~\$8) — because the sun sets mid-task, every time
- ☐ All of it available at any auto parts or big-box store. Prices vary, capability doesn't.

Capability isn't bought — it's built, one checklist at a time. See you out there.
— Roman

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